1 · HARNESS LAYER
fixed overhead, present on every turn

Claude Code's own system prompt
tool definitions · platform · environment

SessionStart hook output
e.g. the corpus-config preflight check

2 · PROJECT ROUTER
CLAUDE.md, auto-loaded by the harness every turn

CLAUDE.md
"drafting content? → read AGENTS.md,
that file and the skill are the whole contract"
+ the one hard rule, stated once: never fabricate a citekey

3 · GOVERNING CONTRACT
read because CLAUDE.md said to

AGENTS.md
citekey invariant in full · the bib file as
source of truth · the four layers · the gate

SOUL.md
the one-page why · tie-breaker on disagreement

4 · SKILL BODY
loaded whole the moment the skill is invoked

.claude/skills/textbook-chapter-writer/SKILL.md
frontmatter + the full 19-step process (0-18)
(name the reader → objectives → scope →
... → gate → render → present)

5 · CROSS-GENRE STANDARDS
pulled in on demand, as steps reach them

docs/WRITING-STANDARDS.md — shared prose rules
docs/DRAFT-ITERATION.md — the dossier's design
docs/PLAGIARISM.md — what the verbatim scan does and does not catch
assets/style/acronyms.toml
+ the user's own file, if config.toml points at one

6 · RUN-SPECIFIC STATE
created and re-read during this run

content/dossiers/<slug>/scope.md
reader · glossary · covers / does-not-cover
content/dossiers/<slug>/retrieval.md
every search() call, logged via --log
content/dossiers/<slug>/rejected.md
worked examples & exercises dropped
content/dossiers/<slug>/steering.md
the user's in-chat asks
content/ledger.sqlite +
chitragupta.retrieval.search() hits

7 · THIS TURN

The user's actual request
topic · reader level · any steering
Relevant entries from the user's own
persistent memory, if any

ALL SEVEN LAYERS, CONCATENATED
are what the model generates against